



Early Winter 2023

Epiphany Perspectives

Epiphany, the season that falls between Christmas and Lent, is a time for us to gain some new perspectives. Utilizing the concept of Liberation Theology, we'll be looking at what the Bible has to say through various perspectives. Liberation Theology is the concept that God has a preferential option for the poor, and it came out of Central American in the late 1960s, and was a radical alternative to the concept that the rich were blessed because they were rich. Since then, many different types of theology have been grouped under the umbrella of Liberation, and we'll be exploring a few of them.

- ✂ January 1 -- one service at 10:00. An introduction to Epiphanies and the series. Communion, *Matthew 2:1-12*
- ✂ January 8 -- Liberation Theology. Baptism Sunday, Infant Recognition, *Isaiah 42:1-9*
- ✂ January 15 -- one service at 10:00. A reading of MLK, Jr.'s *A Letter from a Birmingham Jail* and the singing of spirituals. *Isaiah 9:1-4*
- ✂ January 22 -- Feminist Theology. *Isaiah 49:1-7*
- ✂ January 29 -- Palestinian Liberation Theology. *Micah 6:1-8* (Rev. John Darlington guest preacher)
- ✂ February 5 -- Womanist Theology. Communion, *Isaiah 58:1-12*
- ✂ February 12 -- Eco-Theology. *Deuteronomy 30:15-20*



Pageant 2022 is a wrap! See photos throughout the newsletter!



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United Women in Faith



United
Women
in Faith

Welcome to 2023 and opportunities to be involved in your United Women in Faith!

Let's start with Thank yous!



Your UWF financially supports serving dinners for Simpson Housing services. The Simpson site at 28th and 1st Ave. has been closed as the building was sold by the church to Simpson Housing and it will be torn down and a new, better homeless shelter will be built on the lot. Serving the homeless continues at the temporary site: Zion Lutheran Church at 128 W. 33rd St., about 5 blocks from Simpson Church. A group of Dave Noren, Maureen Trepp, John Darlington, Kitty Campbell, Jenny Ammerman, Paula Barton and Sue Murray served a last dinner at Simpson Church on Nov. 28. Our dinner of our church chicken noodle casserole with sides was enjoyed by 60 people. We will still be serving at the Simpson Church site on Dec. 27 as the move to Zion has not happened yet. We enjoy using food items from the MinneHarvest to plan our meals around. If you'd like to be a server or prep the meals, please let Maureen Trepp know at 612-387-2520 (cell).



We women also had a Night Out on Dec. 8 at Town Hall Lanes. What a great place and what great appetizers, a chance to just socialize and get to know each other better. We hope to sponsor another evening out, running from 4:00-8:00 so women can just drop- in, in March; so watch for it.

We annually distribute our mission funding in December to those missions we have budgeted for and were able to do that once again using funds raised recently at the Annual Bazaar, a great event that successfully serves not only our congregation but neighbors as well. Particularly popular this year was the rice pudding, lefse, baked goods and our Dept. 56 offerings.

We will be having additional sales of our many Dept. 56 items that we have received as a donation. If you didn't know, Dept. 56 items are collectible houses/buildings/people etc. that light up and have been sold by Bachman's for many years. Our collections are many from different series of these creations including North Pole, Bright Lights and Christmas in the City. If you are a collector or know someone who is, you are welcome to contact Maureen Trepp about the series you are interested in or watch for future sales.

Our next fundraising, and our most fun-raising event, is the annual, brought back after 2 years, all church musical which is "Twinderella", a musical about Cinderella and her twin brother Bob. It will be performed Feb. 3 & 4 and 11 & 12 in our Fellowship Hall at differing times. Come! It's fun and all profits go to the missions of your UWF. You'll have a great time!

Peace to all, Maureen Trepp



Kids' "secret" workshop

The Minnehaha Players Present



Twinderella

A glamorous, fun one act story of Cinderella and her twin brother Bob with siblings, Godparents, the Royal Court and more.

Friday, February 3 at 7pm

Saturday, February 4 at 2pm & 7pm

Saturday, February 11 at 7pm

Sunday, February 12 at 2pm

Tickets:

\$10 adults & seniors,; \$6 Children 4-12 years olds

Free to children under 4; Family Rate for 4: \$25

Proceeds go to United Women in Faith to support missions for women and children in our local and global communities

Minnehaha United Methodist Church

3701 E. 50th Ave South, Minneapolis 55417

presented through arrangements with Pioneer Drama Services

Children & Youth Calendar

Sunday Youth Groups 4:00-5:30 pm

Middle Schoolers - Room 302/304 & High Schoolers - Room 308

January 8 & 22

February 5, 12 & 19

Activities include sledding, gym games, indoor bouldering, Super Bowl games and broomball!

Minnehaha Playgroup

Playgroup is returning on Thursdays starting January 5 from 9:30-11:30 am in Rooms 202 & 204.

All children 5 and under and their caretakers are invited to stop in to play, talk, explore, support, and learn together! (Feel free to bring snacks if your child(ren) wants them, but no peanuts.)



Youth Group



SUNDAY SCHOOL AT MINNEHAHA -JANUARY 2023-

January 1

Happy New Year!

January 8
10:15-11:00am

Angel Visits Joseph

January 15
All Families Making Sandwiches

January 22
10:15-11:00am

Escape to Egypt

January 29
10:15-11:00am

Winter Crafts



SUNDAY SCHOOL AT MINNEHAHA -FEBRUARY 2023-

February 5
10:15-11:00am

Light to the Nations

February 12
10:15-11:00am

Lamb of God

February 19

All Church Pancake Breakfast

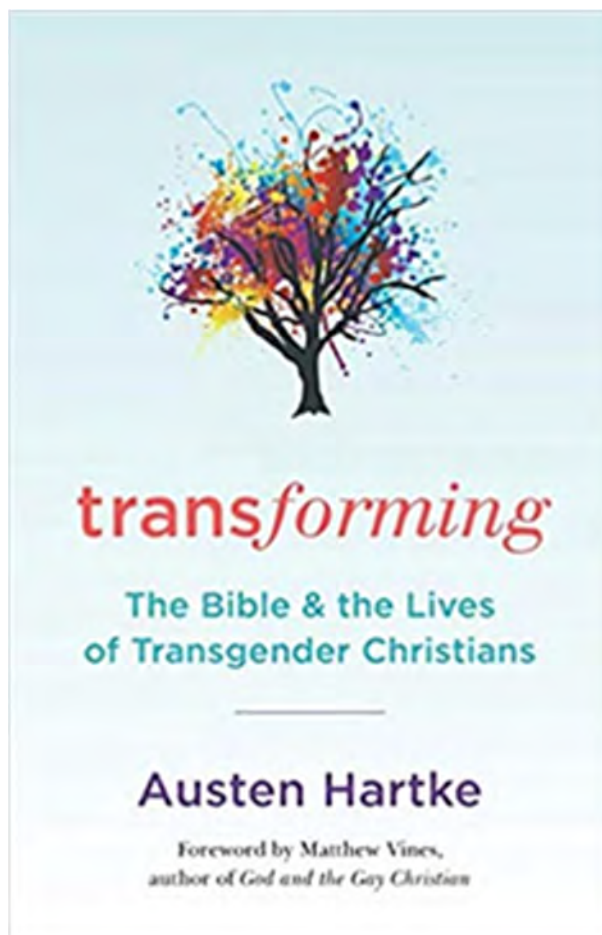
February 26
10:15-11:00am

United in Christ

Taizé

It's easy to get caught up in the daily demands of life. In our busyness, we can lose track of ourselves, and of what God is calling us to be and to do. Take an opportunity to slow down, to rest in silence and music, and to feed your soul. On the second Friday of each month at 7:00 p.m. from October through May, we offer a Taizé service, a time of sanctuary, a time for prayer, a time for community, and a time for silence. As we sing and pray, our hearts are opened so that we may hear God speaking to us, and our souls are fed so that we may be about God's work in the world. Please join us on January 13 and February 10 for a time of renewal. The service is also livestreamed, so you can worship through your screen, wherever you are, either in real time or anytime after.

Family Advent Wreath making



Transforming our Theology

As part of our Epiphany series on New Perspectives, we'll also be reading the book *Transforming: The Bible and the Lives of Transgender Christians* by local author, Austen Hartke. Hartke is a graduate of Luther Seminary. You can read the book on your own, or you can participate in two different opportunities to discuss the book.

- ★ Sunday mornings during Faith Forum, January 22 – February 12.
- ★ Tuesday mornings at 10:00 January 10-31.

Here are the chapters to read for each class:

- ★ Week 1 – Introduction through chapter 2
- ★ Week 2 – Chapters 4-6
- ★ Week 3 – Chapters 7-9
- ★ Week 4 – Chapter 10 through the conclusion

Please order or check out your own copy of the book for the class. Thanks!

Adult Faith Forums

Adult Faith Forums are on Sundays from 10:15-11 in Room 310. Here are the topics for January – March.

- ★ January 8 – The Story of the Bible: Translating the Bible into Modern Languages
- ★ January 15 – No class
- ★ January 22 – Transforming, week 1 (read Introduction through chapter 2)
- ★ January 29 – Transforming, week 2 (read chapters 4-6)
- ★ February 5 – Transforming, week 3 (read chapters 7-9)
- ★ February 12 – Transforming, week 4 (read chapter 10 through the conclusion)
- ★ February 19 – No class



WINTER
Retreat



January 27-29
Lake Koronis Assembly Grounds,
Paynesville, MN

Register now at minnehaha.org

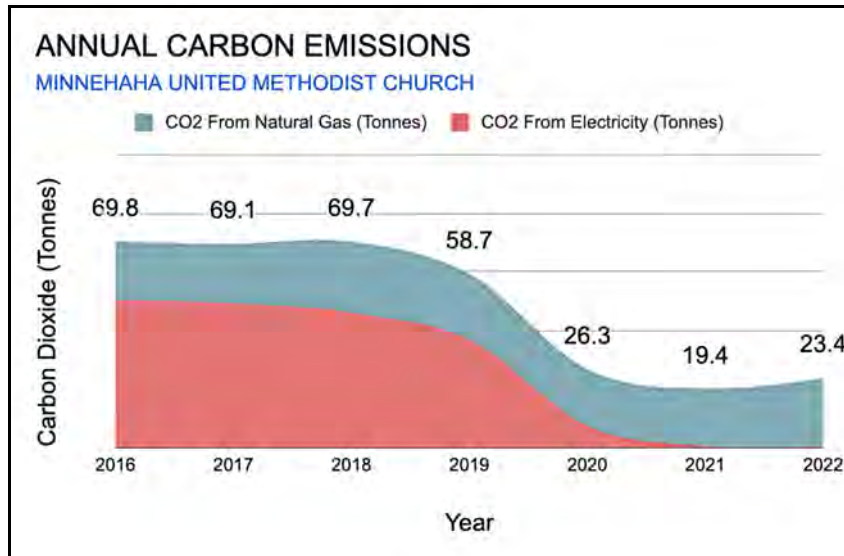


Climate Action Update

In November, we replaced a majority of the canned CFL lights in the narthex and front ramp areas with LED bulbs - cutting the energy demand for these spaces by 64%. Over the winter, we plan additional LED replacements for the narthex cove and sanctuary cove.

Emissions Report

Thanks to our solar array and subscription to Xcel Energy's WindSource program, our annual carbon dioxide emissions have been reduced by 70% from pre-2018 levels. Reducing what remains will be a more difficult challenge. CO₂ emissions in 2022 was calculated at 23.4 metric tonnes - a 20% increase from last year.



Our building-related carbon emissions come solely from natural gas usage. And space heating accounts for nearly 95% of it. We have taken inventory of five different sources of heat for the church building - all of which use natural gas. We have two boilers (primary & secondary), and three HVAC units. Two of the HVAC units are on the roof, and one is housed at the SE corner servicing the Montessori school - all three of which are now over 25 years old. The primary boiler would benefit from a conversion from steam heat to hot-water heat. That conversion is expected to cost \$100,000.

Thanks to donations this past year, we are optimistic that converting at least one of our HVAC units to an electric heat pump model in 2023 is possible. This would be our first significant step in a longer-term goal of decarbonizing our church heating systems. Replacement costs for each rooftop HVAC unit ranges between \$15k - \$25k per unit and about \$60k to replace all three at once.

The Climate Action Committee welcomes your ideas. Email climateaction@minnehaha.org or contact Eric Strom. Our group generally meets the 3rd Monday of the month at 7pm.

MLK Service Weekend

The Sunday of Martin Luther King, Jr. weekend, we will have one worship service at 10:00 with a reading of *"A Letter from a Birmingham Jail"* interspersed with spirituals and gospel songs. Following the service, there will be the opportunity for everyone to make some sandwiches for clients of the Dignity Center and to take home DIY kits of things you can give folks standing out at intersections or exit ramps that aren't cash. Plan to stay after the service for the sandwich-making, and please also bring some cash with you to cover the supplies for the sandwiches.



Minnehaha's Youth made sandwiches for Dignity Center



A small selection of the over 850 toys and gifts distributed during the December Food Shelf! Thanks to everyone who donated!



MinneHarvest

Our free food give-away once a month is a source of food relied upon by many, and it happens through volunteers who come each month. We gather outside on the 4th Saturday of each month. You can volunteer anytime between 6:30 and 10:30 a.m. We start setting up at 6:30, unload the truck starting at 7, serve the food starting around 7:30, and are usually done cleaning up by 10:30. Join us for all or any portion of that time, dress appropriately for the weather, and bring a friend! We'll be offering food on January 28 and February 25.



Young Families *Coffee Hour*



Sunday, January 8
10-11 am in Room 210

Annual Meeting

Our Annual Meeting (otherwise known as a Church Conference) will be held on Sunday, January 22, 2023 at 1:00. We'll have our 2022 Financial Report, our 2022 Membership Report and our 2023 Budget. Everyone is welcome to attend, and all members of the congregation can vote.

Infant Recognition

Sunday
January 8

Join us in worship as we
celebrate all the babies
born this past year in
our community!



Family Fun Sledding Day

Sunday, February 26
1:00 pm

Bundle up
and bring a
sled!

MINNEHAHA UNITED METHODIST CHURCH



Lenses



I just got a pair of new binoculars. Mind you, I have two pair already. But, we have friends who are birders, and they keep inviting us to go birding with them, so we are getting better at birding ourselves. My small pair of binoculars are great for tucking into my pack in the Boundary Waters so we can take a look across a lake and see if a campsite is already occupied. Or see if that's a stump on the shoreline that looks like a bear, or is a bear (it's usually a stump . . .). But when I try to use them to identify small birds, they aren't so great. For that, I have a pair of much larger binoculars. I've used them for our birding outings with our friends, and I've gotten much better about being able to point them

“the Bible ... makes space for all sorts of understandings of God and expressions of humanity”

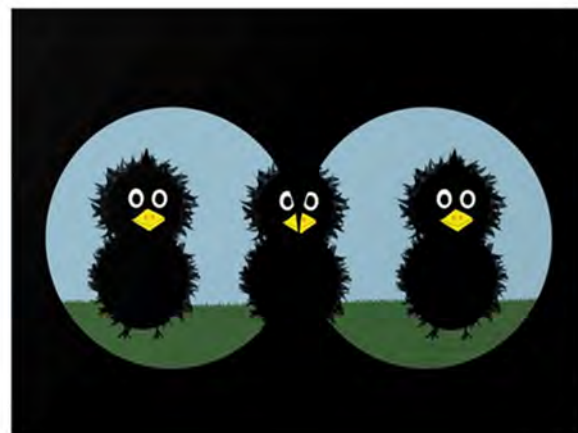
where I'm looking and even follow a bird if it flies off or flutters down to another branch. But they are not waterproof, and they are heavy around my neck. So I got a pair that is the same power, but they are more compact, lighter weight, and waterproof. And in the process, I had to learn about how binoculars work. In simple terms, there is distance, and there is

width. You can look really far off, but then you sacrifice width. A narrower field of vision means less light, and every small movement of your hands or body results in shaking that blurs what you are looking at. Since birds are often small, they move a lot, and they are active at sunrise and sunset, you need binoculars that let you see a good distance, but that don't make it so dark or shaky that you can't see the bird even if it looks close up.

It's not a bad metaphor for our worship and study series this January and February. We are going to be reading the Bible using different binoculars, or lenses. We are going to look at the Bible from the perspective of those who are poor. Or, more correctly, we are going to look at the Bible with the assumption that God cares about the poor. That God cares about BIPOC folk, and women, and that God cares about the ground we walk on, the air we breathe, and the water we drink. And, in conjunction with worship, we are going to read the book *Transforming: The Bible and the Lives of Transgender Christians* by Austen Hartke. Hartke does a wonderful job of pointing out how the Bible is not set up in binary ways (black and white), but makes space for all sorts of understandings of God and expressions of humanity. I hope that you will join in worship and be part of a book study (or at least read the book on your own).

I got my new binoculars now (months before an anticipated birding trip), because it's hard to pick up a new pair of binoculars and use them effectively right away. You need to train your eyes and your hands and arms to work together to spot something and then get the binoculars pointed in the right place. And, it takes practice to learn the field of vision so you know how to move them across the sky so you can keep that flying hawk or swan in sight as they move. In the same way, if we are going to read the Bible in new ways, we have to practice it. If we are used to thinking in black and white, it takes some work to begin seeing the gray. If we are used to only hearing Jesus' parables through our own experience, we need to practice hearing it through the ears of another person to understand the different possibilities for interpretation and experience of God.

Bring your binoculars this Epiphany season! Let's practice changing our focus, spotting the things we normally don't notice, and opening ourselves up to what else God might be doing.



In Joy,
Becky



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1/23

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